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The League — Constitution

Version 6 — adopted September 2026

1.0 League Overview

Welcome to The League!

This is a 12-team league (0.5 PPR as of 2017) that was formed in 2010 *yahoo league*. This league is considered a money league, and all owners are expected to pay their league fee (\$200) before the draft and the current season begins. This league is designed to be a head-to-head competition between owners.

The rules described below are designed to act as a guideline for overall league play, and any disputes will be handled via league vote (majority wins).

Please remember that the overall goal of this league is to have fun and enjoy the game of football. If you have any questions or concerns, please do not hesitate to ask.

1.1 Living Constitution

It is important to note that this is a living, breathing constitution that will change and evolve over the lifetime of this league. Changes will happen between seasons as often as necessary and will be effective from that point moving forward. If you have suggestions for changes, additions or omissions please submit them to the Commissioner. Once a change is made via league vote, the result stands for the following season. Any league matter may be raised again in any subsequent offseason; there is no waiting period. *(Amended by league vote, August 2023, 7-3, which lifted the previous two-year cycle adopted in July 2016.)*

2.0 League Financing

The league fee for The League will be charged to each team owner payable to the commissioner on or before the day of the draft. If a team owner does not have the appropriate entry fee, the owner and commissioner will make necessary arrangements for payment.

If an owner has not paid their league dues by Week 4 of the regular season, said owners will be deducted 5 points per week in their matchup (Starts Week 5) until they have paid in full.

2.1 Prize Money

League prize money will be paid out within seven days of the completion of The League Final. Money will be held in a safe place by The League commissioner and will be paid out in the following manner:

League Champion receives \$1,750 League Runner-Up receives \$300 Weekly high scorer during the regular season (through week 14) receives \$25

2.2 The Sacko

The owner who finishes last in the regular season is the Sacko. The Sacko must deliver a presentation to the league explaining why his team was the worst in the league that season.

This replaces the previous penalty, in which the last-place owner contributed up to \$50 toward food and drink at the following draft. *(Presentation adopted by league vote, August 2026, 7-5. The \$50 food contribution it replaced was adopted unanimously in August 2015 but was never written into any prior version of this constitution.)*

The presentation is delivered at the following season's draft.

3.0 League Setup And Competition

The League will consist of 12 different teams. The schedule will change every season, and each team is to play every team once (1) and three (3) teams twice (2). Schedule to be generated at random every season by The League's fantasy football host site.

3.1 Rankings

Teams will be ranked based on the following criteria:

(1) Head-to-head Record (2) Total Points Scored by the Starters - Year to

Date Tie-breakers will be determined as follows:

1st) Head-to-head Matchup Record 2nd) Total Points Scored by the Bench - Aggregate of weeks 1-14 3rd) Total Points Scored by Starters in the last four (4) weeks of the regular season

3.2 Playoffs

After the completion of the regular season, six teams with the best records will make the playoffs. The #1 & #2 ranked teams have a first-round bye. The #3 ranked team will play the #6 ranked team. The #4 ranked team will play the #5 ranked team. Winners move on to play the #1 and #2 ranked teams, respectively. Single game elimination.

Tie-breaker in the playoffs will be Total Points Scored by Starters in the regular season.

If an NFL game is cancelled or rescheduled such that a playoff matchup cannot be completed as scheduled, the owner with the most points at that time wins the matchup, regardless of the reschedule or cancellation. *(Adopted by league vote, August 2023, 6-3.)*

4.0 Rosters And Lineups

Each roster will consist of 16 active players from any NFL team. Only players from the active roster may be used as part of a team's starting lineup.

4.1 The Draft

The commissioner will designate a draft date and location each season. Owners are expected to attend the draft in person, and must have all league fees paid before the draft.

The draft order is randomized every season. Every owner has an equal chance at every position, regardless of the previous season's finish.

The draft lottery and the consolation bracket that previously set draft position are retired along with keepers, and are no longer in force.

The draft will be a serpentine order, where the person with the first pick in Round 1 will have the last pick in Round 2 and the first pick in Round 3. When it is the owner's turn to draft, they will have ninety (90) seconds to make their pick. The commissioner will designate a timekeeper and when the timer expires, the next owner may make their selection. The skipped owner will auto draft/have highest player on personal cue or highest player based on ESPN's rankings.

4.2 Free Agency

Free Agency will be conducted via “FAAB”. FAAB stands for “Free-Agent Acquisition Budget.” Each team will begin every season with \$100 in FAAB to use as they please. FAAB can be included in trades. All offers will be processed once a week (and then a 1-day Waiver Period after that). If a team would like to add a player, that team will offer the salary amount they are willing to pay. On the next waiver process day, the team with the highest offer will be awarded the player, and the salary amount will be subtracted from that team’s budget. All unclaimed players must go through the waiver process in order to be picked up by a team.

Players who are not claimed during offer processing become free agents available on a first-come, first-serve style pickup basis.

4.3 Trades

Trading is allowed and encouraged in The League, and may be conducted between any two or more owners. Trades may include multiple players from any position, as well as keepers (applicable only during a designated “Keeper Season”), future draft picks and FAAB (\$). Owners can trade draft picks for players up until one (1) hour before the start of the Draft. Trades on a pick-for-player basis will not be allowed during the Draft. During the season, owners are free to trade once the final NFL game of the week is complete. No trades will be allowed after the trade deadline (Wednesday at 12:00PM following week 12 of the NFL season).

4.3.1 Trade Vetoes The league reserves the right to vote on all/any trade (including pre-draft trades) and may veto if they deem inconsistent with league competition and fair-play standards. This veto will only be invoked if it is the majority vote of the league. A tie in votes will result in the trade being accepted. The owners in question may offer reasons why the trade should be allowed, but the decision of the league is final once it has been rendered. Teams involved in trade do not vote.

4.4 Moratorium Period — aka “The Peter Rule”

This section applies only during a designated Keeper Season. With no keepers, there is no offseason roster to protect, so transactions stay open year-round. The Peter Rule is dormant rather than repealed — it returns automatically in any season the league designates as a Keeper Season.

During a Keeper Season, all transactions – including waiver claims and free agent pickups – are halted and disallowed at the end of the fantasy football season. No owner may modify their team in any way during this period. The freeze is lifted the day after the draft order is set, at noon (12:00PM), marking the start of The League’s free agency period. Keeper selections must be finalized before that date, in accordance with the keeper rules established for that season.

(Adopted by league vote, July 2017, 8-2, and reaffirmed August 2023, 8-2. Limited to Keeper Seasons following the retirement of keepers from 2026.)

4.5 Rosters

Rosters in the league will consist of 16 maximum spots with 10 starters and 6 bench, along with 1 IR spot. See below:

Position Starters Maximums QB 1 3 RB 2 7 WR 2 7 TE 1 3 FLEX 2 N/A DEF/SP 1 3 K 1 3 BENCH 6 N/A IR 1 N/A

Owners must submit their starting lineup each week. Players may be added or removed from the starting lineup up until the start time of their respective matches that week. Owners may not change a player that has already played. For example, if you started your quarterback on Thursday night and he has a bad game, you cannot switch him out for a quarterback who has not played. Also, if you did not start a wide receiver who played on Thursday night and he scored three touchdowns, you cannot add him to your lineup on Friday. Once the Thursday game begins, players from that game may not be started or benched. If an owner needs a lineup change after the lineups have been locked, they may contact the commissioner prior to player takes the field and ask for the player to get changed in. If the player has not built any stats the commissioner can make the last-minute change. In unusual circumstances, The League will vote to insert or remove players from lineups.

4.5.1 Failure to Set a Lineup

Owners are required to field a complete and legal starting lineup every week. Failing to do so carries a league penalty. (*Adopted unanimously by league vote, August 2026, 12-0.*)

4.5.2 Eliminated Teams

Once a team is mathematically eliminated from playoff contention, that team's roster is locked. The owner may not add, drop, or trade players for the remainder of the regular season. (*Adopted by league vote, August 2026, 10-2.*)

Elimination is determined by ESPN's own playoff calculation, not by the commissioner's judgement. The lock holds through the end of the regular season.

4.6 Active Ownership Requirements

Each owner is expected to actively manage their team each week, even if they are eliminated from any playoff consideration. Owners must submit a lineup each week, even if their lineup is the same as the previous week. Owners who do not submit a lineup by the start of the first Sunday NFL game will carry-over the previous week's lineup and will not be allowed to change it. If The League deems your team to be "tanking" for any reason, they have the right to vote and insert the best lineup available to you based on ESPN projections.

5.0 Scoring System

Scoring in the league will be computed to two decimal places. This will allow points to be awarded or deducted for every positive or negative yard and will dramatically

reduce the chance of a tie game. Players are awarded fantasy points for each week that they are included in the team's starting lineup. Players may only start at one position in any given week and will only be awarded points as described by their position distinction below.

QB / RB / WR / TE Scoring

0.1 points for every rushing yard (-0.1 points for each negative rushing yard) 0.1 points for every receiving yard (-0.1 points for each negative receiving yard) 0.04 points for every passing yard (-0.04 points for each negative passing yard) 0.5 points for every reception 6.0 points for each touchdown scored (rushing/ receiving/ passing/ fumble recovery/ return) 2.0 points for every 2-point conversion pass 2.0 points for every 2-point conversion run or reception -2.0 points for every interception thrown -2.0 points for every fumble that is recovered by the other team (lost)

Kicker Scoring

1.0 points for every extra point made 3.0 points for every field goal made (39 Yards or less) 4.0 points for every field goal made (40 - 49 yards) 5.0 points for every field goal made (50 Yards or greater) -1.0 points for every missed extra point/field goal

Defense / Special Teams Scoring

2.0 points for every interception and fumble recovery 1.0 points for every sack recorded 2.0 points for every safety recorded 6.0 points for each touchdown scored (fumble recovery, interception return or kick return) 3.0 points for every blocked punt, PAT, or FG 6.0 points for 0 points allowed 4.0 points for 1-6 points allowed 3.0 points for 7-13 points allowed 1.0 points for 14-17 points allowed -1.0 points for 18-27 points allowed -3.0 points for 28-34 points allowed -5.0 points for 35-45 points allowed -7.0 points for 46+ points allowed 5.0 points for less than 100 total yards allowed (YA 100) 4.0 points for 100-199 total yards allowed (YA 199) 3.0 points for 200-299 total yards allowed (YA 299) 2.0 points for 300-349 total yards allowed (YA 349) 1.0 points for 350-399 total yards allowed (YA 399) -1.0 points for 400-499 total yards allowed (YA 499) -2.0 points for 500-549 total yards allowed (YA 549) -3.0 points for 550+ total yards allowed (YA 550) SCORING BONUSES

PASSING: 2.0 points for a 300-399 yard passing game 2.0 points for a 400+ yard passing game (for a total bonus of 4 points) 2.0 points for every 50+ yard TD pass

RUSHING: 2.0 points for a 100-199 yard rushing game 2.0 points for a 200+ yard rushing game (for a total bonus of 4 points) 2.0 points for every 50+ yard TD rush

RECEIVING: 2.0 points for a 100-199 yard receiving game 2.0 points for a 200+ yard receiving game (for a total bonus of 4 points) 2.0 points for every 50+ yard TD reception

5.1 Point Totals and Final Scores

The league will be hosted on ESPN.com. Head to head scoring will be determined each week by the stats from that website. From time to time, the NFL may go back and change the scoring of certain plays later in the week - final score given is what the

league will accept. Each individual owner is responsible for bringing any stat corrections or issues to the Commissioner's attention by the following Tuesday at 11:59pm Eastern Time. Example: If there is an incorrect stat that needs to be changed from Sunday September 10th, then it must be reported to the commissioner no later than Tuesday September 12th at 11:59pm Eastern Time.

5.2 The "Robert Meachum" Rule

In the rare occasion when an offensive player recovers a fumble after an offensive turnover and subsequent defensive team turnover and then advances the ball or scores a touchdown, the offensive player shall be awarded credit for a touchdown or any associated yardage after advancing, as long as the offensive team is on the field when the play starts. In all likelihood, these instances will be all over ESPN and not difficult to identify. However, the commissioner is not responsible for scouring the box scores to identify these instances and the responsibility falls upon the owners to identify them and bring it to the attention of the Commissioner to adjust the scoring. Since team records and points scored influence waivers, owners have until 11:59pm (EASTERN) on Tuesday evening to bring it to the attention of the Commissioner so the proper adjustments can be made. Otherwise, the scoring will be considered final.

5.3 The "Brad Johnson" Rule

In the rare occasion when an offensive player THROWS a pass to himself, the said offensive player will be rewarded with the points for any PASSING YARDS, RECEIVING YARDS, PASSING TOUCHDOWN, AND RECEIVING TOUCHDOWN. Example: Brad Johnson threw a 10 yard pass to himself and scored a touchdown. Had an owner started him that week with this rule in place, Brad would have received .4 points for the PASSING YARDS, 6 points for the PASSING TOUCHDOWN, 1 point for the RECEIVING YARDS, and 6 points for the RECEIVING TOUCHDOWN. This one play would have given Brad Johnson a total of 13.4 points.

6.0 Offseason Activities

Owners are strongly encouraged to maintain contact via group chat. Please make sure to think about your keepers (if the league is in a designated "Keeper Season") for the upcoming season. You should expect to be updated on next years draft (and keeper, if applicable) deadlines via the chat.

6.1 Offseason Rule Change Voting

Every offseason the commissioner will send out a survey to all owners to vote on proposed rule changes. If any one rule change proposal ends in a tie, the rule stays the same.

6.2 League Activation

ESPN locks the Fantasy Football Apps and online programs after the NFL season has concluded to update and improve its system. Once it is ready to reopen (usually some-

time mid summer) they send an email to the League Manager (Alex Escar and current league Commissioner) with a link to reactivate The League. The League Manager will then notify the commissioner and wait for his approval to reactivate The League (refer to Article 4.4 of Constitution). If this link is clicked, it simultaneously reactivates The League and sends an email to EVERY owner notifying them that their league is now active and open for business. It is the Owners' responsibility to maintain an active email address on file and notify the acting commissioner if it changes. Once The League is reactivated, all legal moves, transactions and processes may be conducted within the by-laws of this constitution. All trades will be voted on and all free agents are available to be picked up and kept. ESPN does not allow you to pick up rookies before they begin their NFL careers.